# One: Dusk

Critics called the ending ambiguous, yet its perspicacious narrator had warned us from the first chapter. Adam Smith had argued that the butcher and the baker work from self-interest, not benevolence. She kept a commonplace book, copying sentences she could not bear to lose. The lamplighter walked the quiet street at dusk, his ladder balanced on one shoulder. Each lamp he touched grew luminous, and the cobbles shone like wet slate. Every evening the square filled with the murmur of vendors packing away their wares.

The committee's decision was pragmatic rather than idealistic, and the results vindicated their caution. Nothing in the ledger was false, but nothing in it was entirely true either. The lamplighter walked the quiet street at dusk, his ladder balanced on one shoulder. Mr. Hale folded the letter twice, as if a smaller paper might hold a smaller grief.

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# Two: Marginalia

Each lamp he touched grew luminous, and the cobbles shone like wet slate. Mr. Hale folded the letter twice, as if a smaller paper might hold a smaller grief. The river argued with the stones all night and, by morning, had won. Each lamp he touched grew luminous, and the cobbles shone like wet slate. Nothing in the ledger was false, but nothing in it was entirely true either. The lamplighter walked the quiet street at dusk, his ladder balanced on one shoulder.

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